

SOMAD YESSOUFOU

Senior Backend Engineer | Distributed Systems | AI Applications | .NET | APIs & Messaging

Accra, Ghana | Open to On-Site Opportunities

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer with **10+ years of experience** designing, developing, and operating production-grade backend systems, APIs, distributed applications, and enterprise platforms using **C#, .NET, ASP.NET Core, REST APIs, SQL Server, PostgreSQL, microservices, messaging, Azure, Docker, and CI/CD**.

Strong experience building systems where **correctness, reliability, asynchronous processing, scalability, observability, and production support** are critical. Experienced with **RabbitMQ, MassTransit, event-driven architecture, background processing, distributed services, database design, query optimization, authentication, authorization, and enterprise API integrations**.

Practical experience building **AI-powered applications**, including **BizBot**, an AI-powered business assistant integrating .NET backend services, REST APIs, business data, LLM capabilities, contextual retrieval, and structured application workflows. Experienced in applying AI capabilities to real business problems while keeping core business logic, validation, security, and data operations under deterministic application control.

Experienced across the complete backend lifecycle—from **architecture and implementation through testing, deployment, monitoring, debugging, performance optimization, and production ownership**. Comfortable reasoning about distributed-system failure modes, asynchronous workflows, service communication, database performance, and production reliability.

Experienced using **AI coding agents and AI-assisted development tools** for implementation, debugging, refactoring, test generation, technical investigation, documentation, and validation, while maintaining engineering ownership of architecture, correctness, security, and production quality.

Based in **Accra, Ghana**, with experience working in distributed international engineering teams and a strong interest in building reliable backend infrastructure and intelligent software systems.

CORE ENGINEERING SKILLS

- **Backend:** C#, .NET, .NET 8, ASP.NET Core, Web API, REST, Entity Framework Core, LINQ, Background Services.

- **Distributed Systems:** Microservices, Distributed Systems, Event-Driven Architecture, CQRS, Clean Architecture, Service-Oriented Architecture, Asynchronous Processing, Inter-Service Communication.
- **Messaging & Queues:** RabbitMQ, MassTransit, Queues, Pub/Sub, Event-Based Processing, Background Jobs.
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, SQL Server, MongoDB, Azure Cosmos DB, Relational Data Modeling, SQL, Query Optimization, Database Migrations.
- **Reliability:** Retries, Error Handling, Idempotency Concepts, Fault Diagnosis, Logging, Monitoring, Distributed Tracing, OpenTelemetry, Performance Optimization
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** Microsoft Azure, Docker, Cloud-Native Applications.
- **DevOps:** Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Git, CI/CD, Automated Deployment.
- **Security:** OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect, JWT, RBAC, API Security, Duende Identity Server.
- **AI Engineering:** AI Coding Agents, AI-Assisted Development, AI-Powered Applications, Azure OpenAI, AI-Assisted Debugging, AI-Assisted Testing, Prompt-Assisted Development.
- **Testing:** Unit Testing, Integration Testing, API Testing, Regression Testing, SIT/UAT, Production Validation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

➤ **WIZLYNX GROUP – SWITZERLAND | REMOTE**

Senior Software Developer / Full-Stack .NET Engineer

November 2023 – November 2025

Worked in a distributed international engineering environment building and maintaining enterprise applications, backend services, APIs, security-focused platforms, and integration components.

- Designed and developed **production backend services and RESTful APIs** using C#, .NET, ASP.NET Core, and Entity Framework Core.
- Built and maintained **microservices-oriented applications** using Clean Architecture, separation of concerns, reusable service components, and distributed application patterns.
- Developed asynchronous processing workflows and service communication using **RabbitMQ and MassTransit**.
- Designed backend services to support complex business workflows, integrations, and long-running application processes.
- Worked with **PostgreSQL, SQL Server, MongoDB, and Azure Cosmos DB**, including data modeling and application-level data access.
- Developed and optimized database access components supporting operational workloads and business-critical applications.
- Implemented secure APIs and application workflows using **OAuth 2.0, OpenID Connect, JWT, authentication, authorization, and RBAC**.

- Used **Docker, Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Git, and CI/CD pipelines** to support repeatable software delivery.
- Implemented logging, monitoring, diagnostics, and distributed tracing to improve system observability and production troubleshooting.
- Investigated application failures, integration problems, database issues, and production defects and implemented corrective solutions.
- Participated in architecture discussions, technical design, code reviews, testing, deployment, and production support.
- Contributed to **PhishLynx**, a security-focused enterprise platform involving secure workflows and production-grade application functionality.
- Applied AI-assisted development techniques to accelerate implementation, debugging, refactoring, test development, technical investigation, and engineering productivity.

➤ **PERSOL SYSTEMS LIMITED – GHANA**

Senior Software Developer / Backend Developer

August 2015 – September 2023

Developed and supported enterprise and business-critical applications across financial services, banking-related workflows, payroll, tax revenue, customer information, HCM, and enterprise administration.

- Designed and developed backend applications and APIs using **C#, .NET, ASP.NET MVC, ASP.NET Core, Web API, SQL Server, and Entity Framework**.
- Developed scalable backend services supporting **transaction-oriented business processes and enterprise workflows**.
- Worked on financial and banking-oriented applications involving complex business rules, transactional data, integrations, and secure application workflows.
- Developed integrations between internal enterprise systems and external services using APIs and service-based integration patterns.
- Designed relational database structures and optimized SQL queries and data-access operations.
- Developed **Payroll and Employee Self-Service systems** involving complex business rules, data processing, workflows, and reporting.
- Contributed to **Tax Revenue Applications** and enterprise systems supporting the National Petroleum Authority (NPA).
- Implemented authentication, authorization, RBAC, and secure application workflows.
- Diagnosed and resolved application, database, integration, and production issues.
- Participated in architecture, technical design, development, testing, deployment, maintenance, and production support.
- Collaborated with technical and business stakeholders to translate requirements into maintainable backend solutions.

SELECTED ENGINEERING PROJECTS

➤ **BIZBOT — AI-Powered Business Assistant**

- C#, .NET, ASP.NET Core, Web API, Azure OpenAI / LLM APIs, SQL Server, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, RAG, AI-Assisted Development
- Designed and developed an **AI-powered business assistant** capable of interacting with business information and services through natural-language requests.
- Built backend APIs and service components using **C#, .NET, ASP.NET Core, and RESTful Web APIs** to process user requests and coordinate application/business logic.
- Integrated **Azure OpenAI / LLM capabilities** into backend workflows to generate contextual responses while keeping deterministic business operations under application control.
- Implemented backend processing for AI requests, including request validation, business-context retrieval, response handling, error management, and structured responses.
- Explored **Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)** and contextual retrieval patterns to ground AI responses in relevant business information rather than relying solely on model-generated knowledge.
- Worked with **SQL Server and PostgreSQL** for business data and application persistence, including retrieving structured information that could be used as context for AI interactions.
- Designed REST APIs and service components to separate **AI/LLM functionality from deterministic application logic**, improving maintainability and control over business operations.
- Applied secure API communication, authentication/authorization patterns, validation, and error handling to AI-enabled application workflows.
- Used AI coding tools throughout development for implementation acceleration, debugging, refactoring, test generation, technical investigation, and validation.
- Investigated practical approaches for combining **LLMs, business data, APIs, structured responses, and backend services** to create useful enterprise AI capabilities.

➤ **Distributed Banking / Financial Services Platform**

- C# | .NET | ASP.NET Core | Web API | SQL Server | Microservices | Azure
- Developed backend services supporting financial and transaction-oriented workflows.
- Designed APIs for communication between application services and enterprise systems.
- Worked with complex transactional data and business rules.
- Applied secure authentication, authorization, and service communication patterns.
- Supported testing, troubleshooting, performance optimization, and production maintenance.

➤ **MicroNet Banking Application**

- C# | .NET | ASP.NET Core | Web API | SQL Server | Microservices

- Developed backend services and APIs for banking-oriented business operations.
- Implemented business logic and data-access components using .NET and Entity Framework.
- Worked with transactional data and complex business workflows.
- Applied service-oriented and microservices architecture principles.

➤ **Customer Onboarding & CRM Platform**

- .NET | ASP.NET Core | Web API | SQL Server | Microservices | Azure
- Built backend services supporting customer onboarding and CRM workflows.
- Implemented API integrations and service-to-service communication.
- Developed workflow-based business processes and secure access controls.

ENGINEERING STRENGTHS

- **Distributed Systems:** Experience designing service boundaries, asynchronous workflows, microservices, messaging, queues, event-driven processing, and inter-service communication.
- **Backend Reliability:** Experience diagnosing production failures, improving observability, handling asynchronous processing, optimizing database operations, and designing systems for maintainability and operational reliability.
- **API Engineering:** Strong experience designing and implementing RESTful APIs, integration services, secure endpoints, and backend service contracts.
- **Database Engineering:** Strong SQL background with **SQL Server and PostgreSQL**, including schema design, data access, migrations, transactional workloads, and query optimization.
- **Production Ownership:** Comfortable taking backend systems from architecture and implementation through testing, deployment, monitoring, troubleshooting, and ongoing improvement.
- **AI-Assisted Engineering:** Experienced using AI tools as an engineering accelerator for implementation, debugging, refactoring, testing, documentation, technical research, and code validation.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science / Information Technology

Sikkim Manipal University | 2015

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Microsoft Azure / Cloud Engineering – Microsoft Learn
- Advanced .NET & ASP.NET Core – Microsoft Learn
- Microservices Architecture – Microsoft Learn

- Distributed Systems – Microsoft Learn
- DevOps & CI/CD – Microsoft Learn
- AI-Assisted Software Engineering – Microsoft Learn

LANGUAGES

- **English:** Professional proficiency
- **French:** Professional proficiency

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Location:** Accra, Ghana
- **Work preference:** On-site, hybrid, remote, and international opportunities
- **Experience:** 10+ years software engineering
- **Primary backend language:** C#
- **Primary backend ecosystem:** .NET / ASP.NET Core
- **International experience:** Switzerland / Ghana / distributed engineering teams
- **Available for:** Backend engineering, distributed systems, AI infrastructure, platform engineering, and AI-powered application development